Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Analysing a practitioner without copying the page

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do we conduct rigorous visual analysis of a practitioner's work through annotated studies rather than biography copying?

Arrival check

What is the biggest mistake students make on artist research pages, and how do real studio artists avoid it?

[ ] Copying paragraphs of Printed text biography instead of analysing how the artwork actually works visually!

[ ] Real studio pages use small analytical drawings — like a tonal map and a mark close-up — with pointer notes

[ ] Every study should end by adapting the technique to your own original idea

Starter visual cues

Box 1 (Compositional tonal Map — 5 mins): A quick 6 cm thumbnail reducing the whole artwork to 3 tones (dark, mid, light) to show how the eye is led.

Box 2 (Process transcription — 10 mins): A close-up study reverse-engineering the exact layer order and mark rhythm.

Box 3 (Personal adaptation — 10 mins): A new sketch applying that tonal structure and layer recipe to your OWN identity motif.

Analytical pointer notes connect all three boxes.

Vote: Why is drawing a quick 3-tone 'tonal map' thumbnail of an artwork so revealing?

Studio practice planner

Build your three-box practitioner analysis without biography filler.

Shapes/Focus: Box 1: 3-value tonal skeleton, Box 1: Focal contrast halo, Box 1: Asymmetric balance map, Box 1: Counterchange grid

Tools/Methods: Box 2: Wash + pastel resist, Box 2: Cross-contour hatching, Box 2: Collage + brush contour, Box 2: Dry-brush over dark ground

Exit ticket

What is the purpose of drawing a simplified 3-value 'tonal map' when analysing an artwork?

[ ] To reveal the underlying structure of darks, mid-tones, and lights that directs the viewer's eye to the focal point

[ ] To copy the artist's date of birth

[ ] To avoid using dark tones